POL310 · Guest lecture 1 of 2

Who Gets to Stay, and on What Terms

Immigration, incorporation, and the psychology of hostility in Europe

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About me

Who I am and why I am here

Teaching

Politics of the EU

I teach POL309, Politics of the European Union, in fall and spring. Some of you are in it. This week is built so you will not hear the same lecture twice.

Research area

Political psychology

National identity, nostalgia, conspiracy beliefs, and dehumanization: the psychology underneath much of today's immigration politics.

Scan for my website

This week

Three courses, six pieces of the same story

Course	When	Focus	What it adds
POL309	Week 10 · Oct 26, 28	The migration crisis, part I	Schengen, the asylum system, Dublin's basic rule, 2015, relocation, EU–Turkey
POL310	**Tue Oct 27**	**Europe: who stays, and on what terms**	**Integration models, citizenship, civic tests, the radical right, the psychology of hostility**
POL310	Thu Oct 29	The United States	Institutions, enforcement, public opinion, partisanship, and independents
GLI330	Tue Oct 27	Dublin III	The hierarchy of criteria, procedures, courts, cooperation as an IR problem
GLI330	Thu Oct 29	After Dublin	Ukraine, the 2024 Pact, externalization, instrumentalization, ethics
POL309	Week 11 · Nov 2–6	The psychology of compassion	Alan Kurdi, the empathy debate

POL309 = Politics of the European Union · POL310 = Politics of Immigration and Refugees · GLI330 = Globalization and IR: Human Mobility

Today’s plan

1. Admission is only the beginning: what it takes to be incorporated
2. National models, civic integration, and citizenship
3. The backlash: the populist radical right and its contagion
4. The psychology of hostility: identity, disgust, dehumanization, nostalgia, conspiracy
5. What reduces hostility, and what does not

Warm-up · 3 minutes

What should it take to become “one of us”?

A

Be born here

B

Live here for years

C

Speak the language

D

Share core values

E

Work and pay taxes

Pick the one requirement that matters most to you. Hold on to your answer; we come back to it at the end.

Options adapted from the ISSP National Identity module (ISSP Research Group, 2015, ZA5950), which asks how important each is for being “truly” a member of the nation

1

Border admission is only the beginning

Immigration policy versus immigrant policy

Most immigrants who arrive stay, so what follows is a politics of membership

Immigration policy

Who gets in?

- Visas, quotas, labor schemes
- Asylum and refugee admission
- Border control and removal

Immigrant policy · today

On what terms do they stay?

- Residence security and family life
- Rights at work, in school, in welfare
- Language, civic tests, and contracts
- Citizenship: the end point, or not?

POL309 covered this last week; GLI330 this week.

Hammar, European Immigration Policy: A Comparative Study (1985); Hammar, Democracy and the Nation State (1990), on “denizens”

About one in ten people living in the EU was born outside it

~29m

non-EU citizens living in the EU, about 6.4% of residents

45m

EU residents born outside the EU, close to 1 in 10

4.3m

people from Ukraine under temporary protection

"Immigrant" covers EU movers, third-country nationals, refugees, and naturalized citizens: very different legal statuses, and very different rights.

Eurostat, "Migration and migrant population statistics," data, January 2024; Eurostat, "Temporary protection for persons fleeing Ukraine," monthly statistics, end of 2024 · figures rounded

Brussels sets rules for entry and residence; capitals decide integration policy

EU level

Entry and residence rights

Common rules for family reunification, long-term residence, highly skilled workers, and anti-discrimination, under Article 79 TFEU.

National level

Integration and citizenship

Language courses, civic tests, naturalization, religion in public life. The EU may support and coordinate, but may not harmonize.

“...excluding any harmonisation of the laws and regulations of the Member States.”

TFEU Art. 79(4), on EU measures to promote integration

Treaty on the Functioning of the European Union, Art. 79(1)–(4); Directive 2003/86/EC, Art. 7(2)

What Brussels does oversee: five directives

Instrument	What it does
Racial Equality Directive (2000)	Bans discrimination on grounds of racial or ethnic origin in work, services, and housing
Family Reunification Directive (2003)	Right to bring core family; states may require “integration measures”
Long-term Residents Directive (2003)	After five years’ legal residence: secure status and equal treatment in many areas
Blue Card Directive (2009, recast 2021)	Common entry route for highly qualified workers
Single Permit Directive (2011, recast 2024)	One procedure for work and residence permits

Directives 2000/43/EC; 2003/86/EC; 2003/109/EC; 2009/50/EC, recast as (EU) 2021/1883; 2011/98/EU, recast as (EU) 2024/1233 · Official Journal of the European Union

Officially, integration is a two-way street

“Integration is a dynamic, two-way process of mutual accommodation by all immigrants and residents of Member States.

Common Basic Principle 1, Council of the EU, 2004

Four priority areas, 2021–2027

Education Early childhood to adult skills	**Employment** Recognition of qualifications
Health Access to services	**Housing** Against segregation

Two-way in principle. In practice, who carries the burden?

Council of the EU, Common Basic Principles for Immigrant Integration Policy, Doc. 14615/04 (Nov 19, 2004); European Commission, Action Plan on Integration and Inclusion 2021–2027, COM(2020) 758

2

National models, and why they converged

France, Germany, the Netherlands, and the end of the old typologies

How a nation imagines itself sets the price of citizenship

France

Civic and territorial

- Nation built by the state; membership through residence and schooling
- Birth in France plus residence leads to citizenship (jus soli)
- Expectation: become French, keep difference private

Germany

Ethnocultural

- Nation before the state; membership by descent
- 1913 law: citizenship by blood (jus sanguinis)
- Guest workers recruited from 1955: present for decades, rarely citizens

A caution: Weil shows French law was shaped by politics and demography as much as by an idea of the nation.

Brubaker, Citizenship and Nationhood in France and Germany (1992); Weil, How to Be French: Nationality in the Making since 1789 (2008)

Four models of national belonging

Pluralist recognizes group difference

Monist one public culture

Ethnic pluralism

Separate cultural life, little access to citizenship

Germany and Switzerland before 2000

Multiculturalism

Easy citizenship and group recognition

Netherlands, Sweden, United Kingdom

Ethnic assimilation

Hard citizenship and pressure to conform

Austria; Denmark, more recently

Assimilationism

Easy citizenship, one public culture

France

← Ethnic: citizenship by descent

Civic-territorial: citizenship by residence →

Adapted from Koopmans, Statham, Giugni and Passy, Contested Citizenship (2005); Koopmans, Michalowski and Waibel, American Journal of Sociology 117(4), 2012 · placements approximate, around 2000

Leaders renounced multiculturalism; states mostly kept the policies

Oct 2010

Angela Merkel: the multicultural approach has “utterly failed” in Germany

Feb 2011

David Cameron, in Munich: “state multiculturalism” has failed

Feb 2011

Nicolas Sarkozy agrees, on French television

2000–2010 Multiculturalism Policy Index: most measured policies persist, and some strengthen.

Merkel, speech to the Junge Union, Potsdam, Oct 16 2010; Cameron, speech at the Munich Security Conference, Feb 5 2011; Sarkozy, TF1 “Paroles de Français,” Feb 10 2011; Banting and Kymlicka, Comparative European Politics 11(5), 2013; Joppke, West European Politics 30(1), 2007

Different national traditions converged on “civic integration”

1998
Netherlands: Newcomer Integration Act makes courses mandatory

2005
Germany: Immigration Act creates national integration courses

2006
Netherlands: civic integration exam taken abroad, before entry

2007
France: reception and integration contract made mandatory

2008
Germany: national naturalization test introduced

Joppke calls the result “repressive liberalism”: liberal ends, such as autonomy and equality, pursued through coercive means.

Joppke, “Beyond National Models,” West European Politics 30(1), 2007; Goodman, Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies 36(5), 2010; Goodman, Immigration and Membership Politics in Western Europe (2014)

Activity

Could you pass?

Germany

Naturalization test: 33 multiple-choice questions, 17 correct to pass.

People may openly criticize the government. Which basic right allows this?

Denmark

Citizenship test, heavy on history and culture.

In which year did Denmark adopt its first democratic constitution?

Netherlands

Civic integration exam: norms of work and daily life.

Your manager asks for your opinion in a meeting. What is the expected response?

France

Assimilation interview on values, history, and rights.

What are the three words of the motto of the Republic?

Which questions test knowledge, which test values, and which test culture? How many native-born citizens would pass?

Items written in the style of: Germany, BAMF Einbürgerungstest; Denmark, Indfødsretsprøven; Netherlands, Inburgeringsexamen (Kennis van de Nederlandse Maatschappij); France, entretien d'assimilation (Code civil, art. 21-24)

Debrief

If tests barely change outcomes, what are they for?

Selects who stays

Screening

Fees, language levels, and test difficulty filter by education and class as much as by commitment.

Speaks to voters

Signaling

Tests show natives that the state is “in control” of who belongs. The audience is the electorate, not the migrant.

Teaches a nation?

Socializing

Courses can build language and networks. The evidence that requirements improve measurable outcomes is weak.

Goodman, Immigration and Membership Politics in Western Europe (2014); Goodman and Wright, Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies 41(12), 2015; Michalowski and van Oers, Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies 38(2), 2012

Citizenship law is where a country decides who its people are

Germany

1913

Citizenship by descent; guest workers' children stay foreigners

2000

Conditional birthright citizenship for children of long-term residents

2024

Naturalization after five years; dual citizenship broadly allowed

2025

New coalition scraps the three-year fast track

Reward or catalyst?

In Swiss towns that voted on applications, narrowly winning citizenship raised immigrants' later political and social integration.

Reichs- und Staatsangehörigkeitsgesetz (1913); Staatsangehörigkeitsgesetz reforms of 2000 and 2024; Bundestag vote, October 2025; Hainmueller, Hangartner and Pietrantuono, PNAS 112(41), 2015, and American Political Science Review 111(2), 2017

Formal equality and lived equality are different measurements

2004

France bans conspicuous religious symbols in state schools

2010

France bans face coverings in public

2014

ECtHR upholds the ban in S.A.S. v. France

2017

CJEU, Achbita: employers may adopt neutrality rules

2.5×

In a French field experiment, an otherwise identical Senegalese Christian applicant was about 2.5 times as likely as a Senegalese Muslim applicant to get a callback.

Loi n° 2004-228; Loi n° 2010-1192; S.A.S. v. France, ECtHR [GC], no. 43835/11, 2014; Achbita, C-157/15, CJEU, 2017; Adida, Laitin and Valfort, PNAS 107(52), 2010; Adida, Laitin and Valfort, Why Muslim Integration Fails in Christian-Heritage Societies (2016)

3

The backlash

The populist radical right and its contagion

For the populist radical right, immigration is not one issue among many. It is the organizing one

Core

Nativism

The state should belong to the native group; non-native people and ideas threaten the homogeneous nation.

+

Authoritarianism

Belief in a strictly ordered society, in which infringements of authority are punished severely.

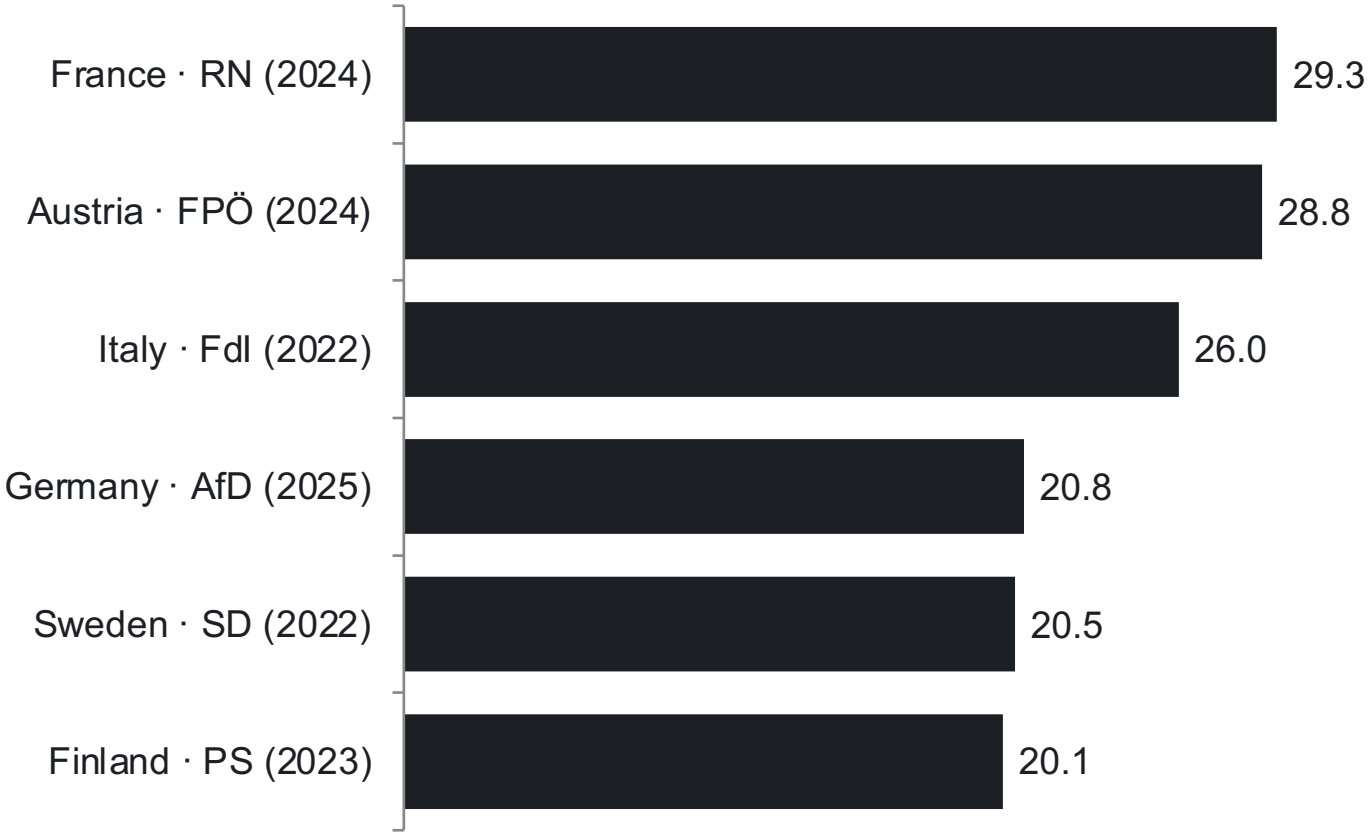
+

Populism

A pure people against a corrupt elite; politics as the expression of the general will.

Mudde, Populist Radical Right Parties in Europe (2007); Mudde, The Far Right Today (2019); Rydgren, Annual Review of Sociology 33, 2007

One in five to nearly one in three voters now choose the radical right



Italy

The radical right leads the government.

Austria

The FPÖ came first.

Germany

The AfD finished second in 2025, its best federal result.

Official results: France, Ministère de l'Intérieur (2024, RN first round, legislative); Austria, BMI (2024); Italy, Ministero dell'Interno (2022, Chamber); Germany, Bundeswahlleiterin (2025, second vote); Sweden, Valmyndigheten (2022); Finland, Ministry of Justice (2023) · % of valid votes

Contagion: Copying the radical right does not reward the mainstream

Radical right gains votes → **Issue salience rises** → **Mainstream parties shift right on immigration** → **Voters reward the party that started the shift**

Abou-Chadi and Krause (2020)

The shift is real

Radical right success moves mainstream positions on immigration and multiculturalism, even before the radical right wins seats.

Krause, Cohen and Abou-Chadi (2023)

The payoff is not

Accommodation does not reduce radical right support, and may legitimize it. Voters prefer the original to the copy.

Meguid, American Political Science Review 99(3), 2005; Meguid, Party Competition between Unequals (2008); Abou-Chadi and Krause, British Journal of Political Science 50(3), 2020; Krause, Cohen and Abou-Chadi, Political Science Research and Methods 11(1), 2023

4

The psychology of hostility

Identity, disgust, dehumanization, nostalgia, and conspiracies

Opposition to immigration is mostly about the immigrants, not personal financial situations

Economic threat

“They take our jobs”

- Predicts less than expected: workers in competing jobs are not much more opposed
- Concern is sociotropic: about the nation’s economy, not one’s own
- Group threat grows with the perceived size of the outgroup

Cultural threat

“They change who we are”

- Dutch experiments: identity threats trigger exclusion more than economic ones
- Strongest among those with a strong sense of national identity
- Activated by situational triggers: events, rhetoric, media

Hainmueller and Hiscox, American Political Science Review 104(1), 2010; Sniderman, Hagendoorn and Prior, American Political Science Review 98(1), 2004; Quillian, American Sociological Review 60(4), 1995; Hainmueller and Hopkins, Annual Review of Political Science 17, 2014

Exclusive nationalism: The question is not whether people love their country, but where they draw its border in their heads

Attachment

“I feel part of this nation”

A sense of personal belonging. It can coexist with openness to newcomers.

Nationalism

“We are better than others”

A belief in national superiority, consistently linked with hostility toward outgroups.

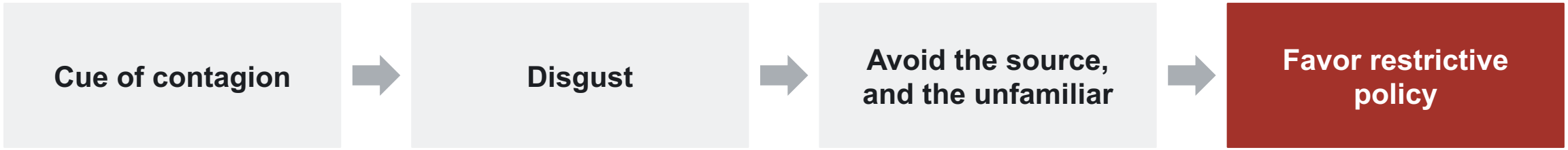
Boundaries

Who counts as one of us

Ethnic definitions of the nation predict exclusion. Civic definitions do so much less.

Kosterman and Feshbach, Political Psychology 10(2), 1989; Huddy and Khatib, American Journal of Political Science 51(1), 2007; Wright, Citrin and Wand, Political Psychology 33(4), 2012

Disgust: an evolutionary disease-avoidance system that over-generalizes to strangers



Faulkner et al. (2004)

Vulnerability

Feeling vulnerable to disease predicts xenophobia toward unfamiliar groups.

Aarøe, Petersen and Arceneaux (2017)

Disgust sensitivity

Predicts opposition to immigration in the United States and Denmark.

Schaller and Park, Current Directions in Psychological Science 20(2), 2011; Faulkner, Schaller, Park and Duncan, Group Processes & Intergroup Relations 7(4), 2004; Navarrete and Fessler, Evolution and Human Behavior 27(4), 2006; Aarøe, Petersen and Arceneaux, American Political Science Review 111(2), 2017

Refugees and undocumented migrants are often placed in the “disgust” quadrant

High warmth	**Pity** Warm but incompetent: older people, disabled people	**Pride** Warm and competent: the ingroup, allies
Low warmth	**Disgust** Cold and incompetent: the homeless, often refugees and undocumented migrants	**Envy** Cold but competent: the rich, “model minorities”
	← Low competence	High competence →

In Harris and Fiske’s scans, the medial prefrontal cortex, usually engaged when we think about other people, was less active only for groups in this quadrant.

Fiske, Cuddy, Glick and Xu, Journal of Personality and Social Psychology 82(6), 2002; Lee and Fiske, International Journal of Intercultural Relations 30(6), 2006; Harris and Fiske, Psychological Science 17(10), 2006

A dead salmon “passed” a social-cognition test

The subject

One Atlantic salmon, 18 inches, 3.8 lbs, which was “not alive at the time of scanning”

The task

Shown photos of people in social situations and asked what emotion is this person feeling?

The analysis

About 130,000 voxels, each tested separately, at the field’s usual $p < .001$

Uncorrected

81 mm^3

An “active” cluster in the brain cavity, and another in the spine

Corrected (FDR, FWER)

0

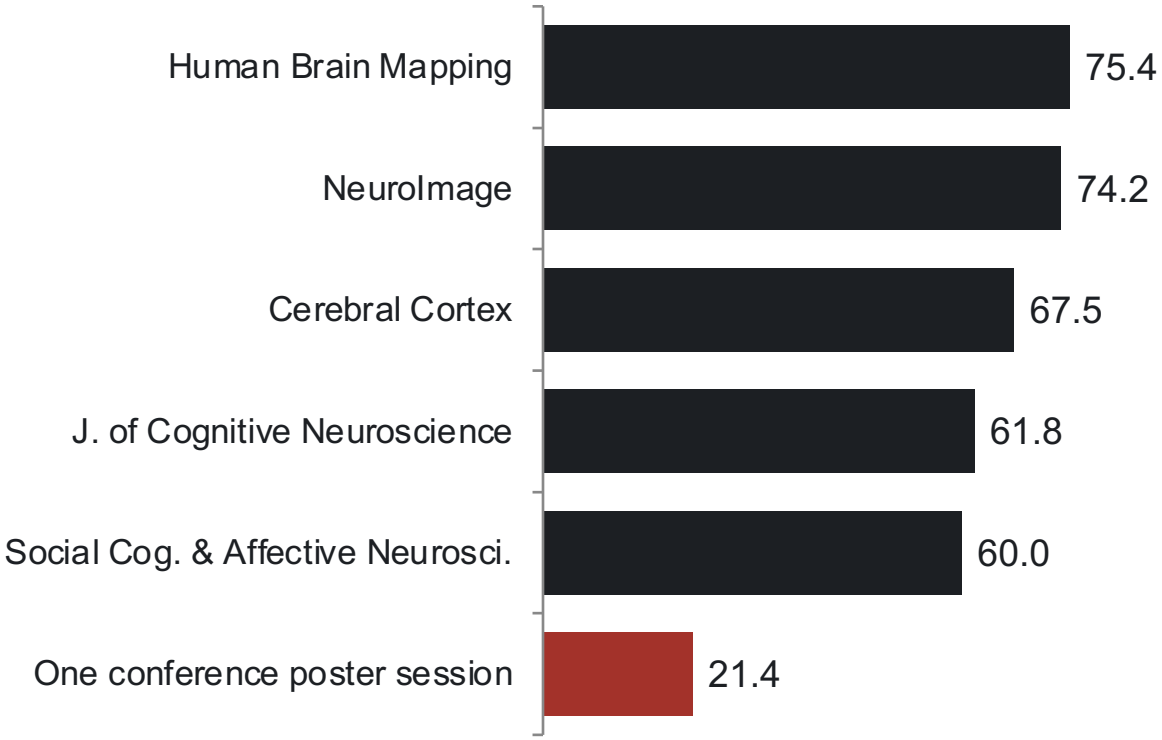
No active voxels, even at relaxed thresholds of 0.25

The fish was not thinking, yet the scan showed activity. Sophisticated tools can produce sophisticated noise.

Bennett, Baird, Miller and Wolford, “Neural Correlates of Interspecies Perspective Taking in the Post-Mortem Atlantic Salmon,” Journal of Serendipitous and Unexpected Results 1(1), 2010

Treat a brain scan study as one piece of evidence, never as a full picture of the mind

Share of 2008 fMRI studies that corrected for multiple comparisons (%)



1

Was it corrected?

130,000 tests at p < .001 means about 130 chance "hits" if each voxel were independent.

2

Does activity mean thought?

Reverse inference: a lack of activity in a region is not proof of an attitude or bias. Someone is not provably seen as less than human because the mPFC does not light up.

3

Does other evidence agree?

Dehumanization holds up because surveys and behavior converge, as the next slides show.

Bennett et al. (2010), counts of 2008 articles: HBM 43/57, NeuroImage 193/260, Cerebral Cortex 54/80, JoCN 42/68, SCAN 15/25, one poster session 9/42; Poldrack, Trends in Cognitive Sciences 10(2), 2006; Vul, Harris, Winkielman and Pashler, Perspectives on Psychological Science 4(3), 2009

The “Ascent of Man”: an explicit measure of attitudes

0 · least “evolved”



fully “evolved” human · 100

Blatant

Openly “less than”

Respondents openly rate groups as less than fully human. No implicit measure is needed.

Predictive

Beyond prejudice

Lower ratings predict support for torture, harsh policing, and restriction, beyond dislike.

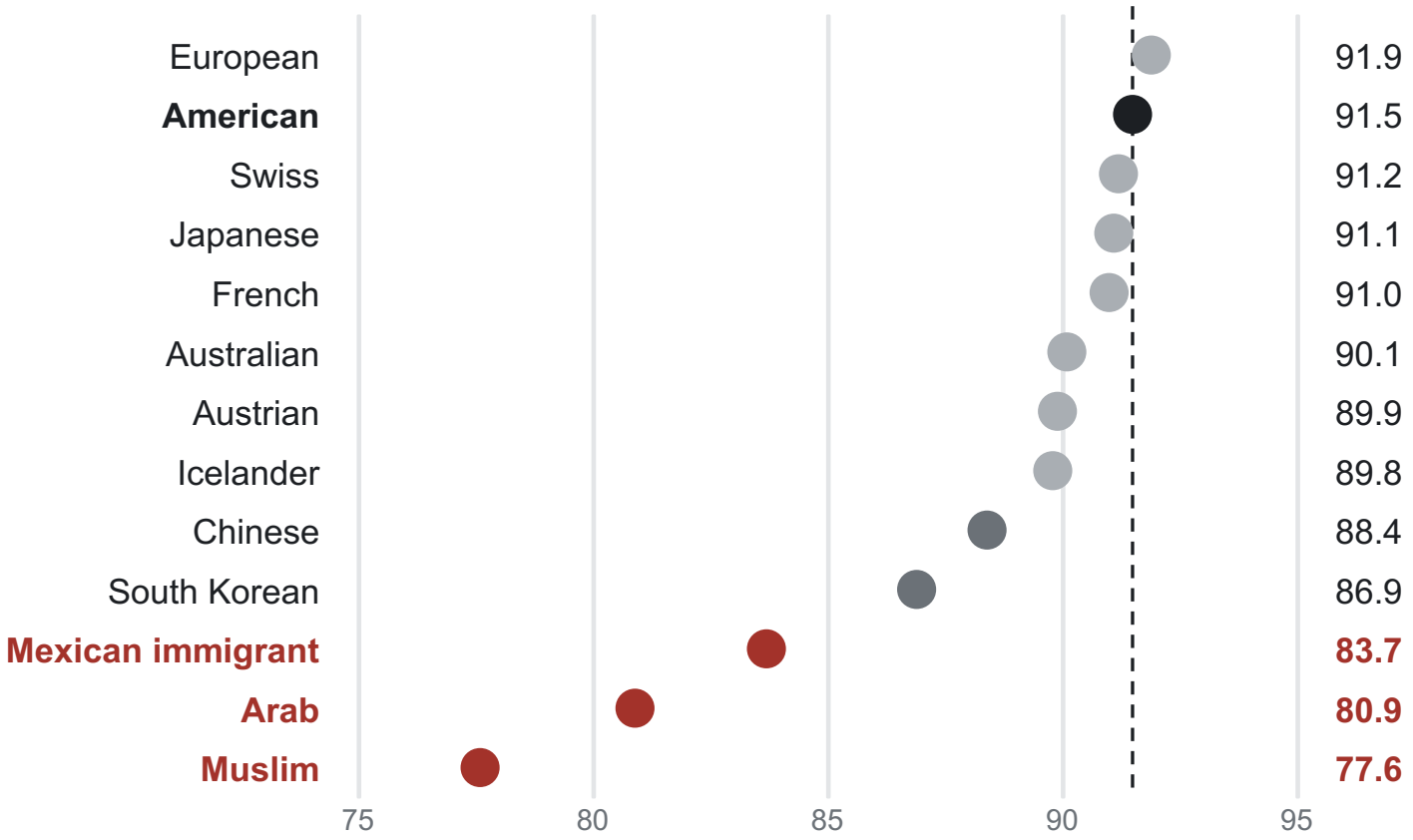
Reciprocal

It comes back

Groups who feel dehumanized dehumanize in return, which fuels conflict.

Kteily, Bruneau, Waytz and Cotterill, Journal of Personality and Social Psychology 109(5), 2015; Kteily, Hodson and Bruneau, Journal of Personality and Social Psychology 110(3), 2016

Where Americans placed 13 groups on the Ascent scale



Mean rating, 0 = least "evolved," 100 = fully "evolved" (axis zoomed to 75–95)

Points below Americans

−14.0 Muslims

−10.6 Arabs

−7.9 Mexican immigrants

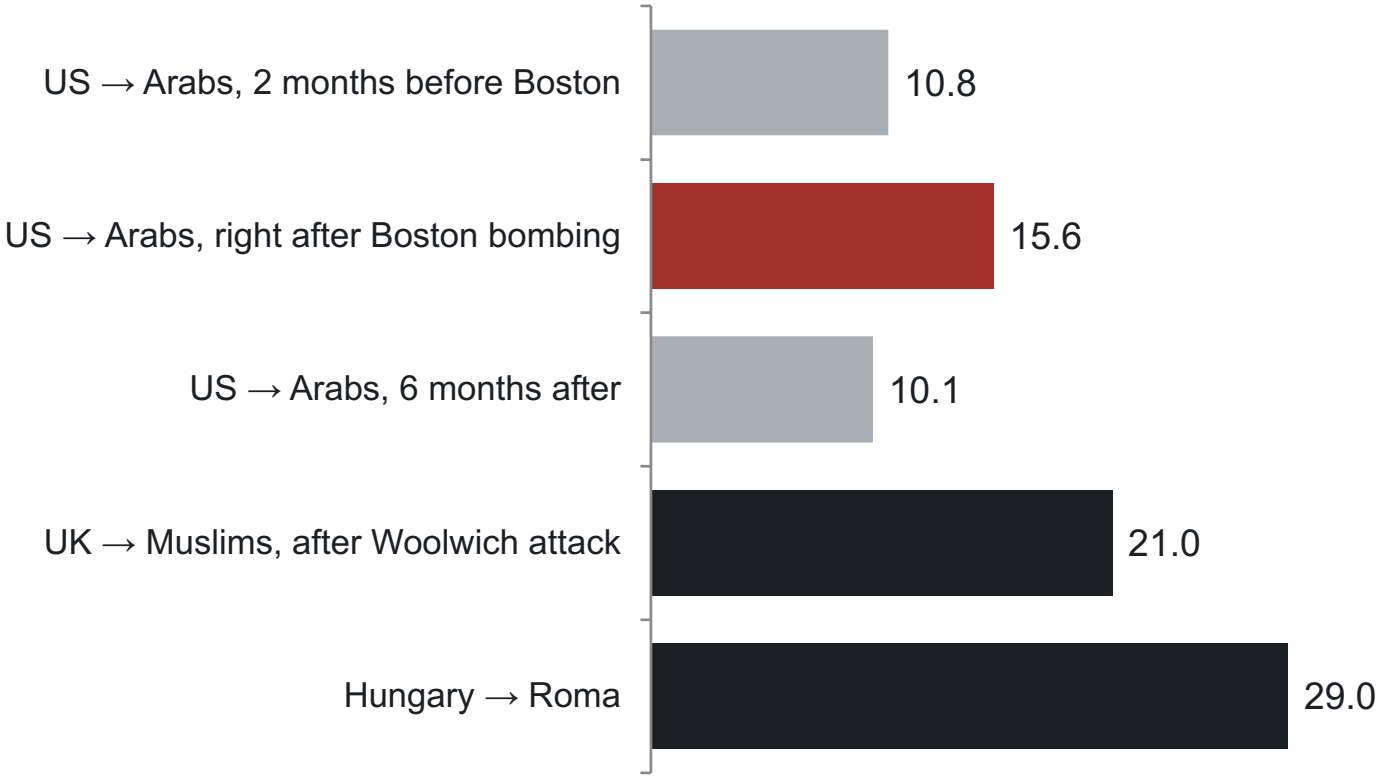
Most medians were 100: a minority answers bluntly. One in four respondents put Muslims at 60 or below.

- Same as Americans
- Lower, p < .01
- Lower, p < .001

Kteily, Bruneau, Waytz and Cotterill, JPSP 109(5), 2015, Study 1, Table 1 · N = 172 US adults (MTurk) · dashed line = rating of Americans · standard deviations (15–30) not shown

Blatant dehumanization is a minority view that spikes after violence

Ascent gap: own group's rating minus outgroup's rating (0–100 scale)



Violence moves it

The gap for Arabs jumped by half after the Boston bombing, then returned to baseline.

Europe is not immune

British and Hungarian samples show larger gaps than the US baseline.

It predicts policy

Larger gaps predicted support for torture, discrimination, and cutting integration funds.

Kteily et al., JPSP 109(5), 2015: pilot samples and Study 3A (Boston), Study 3B (Woolwich), Study 4 (Hungary, representative sample) · Hungarian ratings collected on a 0–10 slider, multiplied by 10

You can feel sorry for people you do not see as fully human

Europe, 2015: four national samples

Czech Republic	Hungary	Spain	Greece
N = 1,307	N = 502	N = 1,049	N = 934

- Blatant dehumanization of Muslim refugees was prevalent in all four countries
- It was higher, and more tightly linked to behavior, in the two Central European samples
- It predicted anti-refugee attitudes and behavior beyond ideology, prejudice, and empathy

Empathy and humanization are different psychological processes.

Bruneau, Kteily and Laustsen, European Journal of Social Psychology 48(5), 2018

Swarms, floods, poison: how words we choose dehumanize

Animal and insect

“A swarm of people”

David Cameron, on migrants at Calais, July 2015.

Natural disaster

“Floods,” “waves,” “tides”

Common across European tabloids and party campaigns.

Disease and poison

“Not medicine but poison”

Viktor Orbán, describing migration, July 2016.

In experiments, such language raises anger and disgust and lowers support for immigration.

Cameron, interview with ITV News, 30 July 2015; Orbán, press conference, Budapest, 26 July 2016; Esses, Medianu and Lawson, Journal of Social Issues 69(3), 2013; Utych, Political Research Quarterly 71(2), 2018

“Make _____ great again”: the pull of a misremembered past

Then *“Our group was central”*

Now *“We have been pushed aside”*

Nostalgic deprivation

van Prooijen et al. (2022)

Nostalgia and populism

Collective nostalgia is associated with populist attitudes. The past serves as a standard against which elites have failed.

Gest, Reny and Mayer (2018)

Nostalgic deprivation

Perceived loss of status from past to present. Predicts radical right support in Britain and the United States.

Smeekes et al. (2015)

National nostalgia

Dutch samples: longing for the “good old days” predicts opposition to Muslim expressive rights.

van Prooijen, Rosema, Chemke-Dreyfus, Trikaliti and Hormigos, Political Psychology 43(5), 2022; Gest, Reny and Mayer, Comparative Political Studies 51(13), 2018; Smeekes, Verkuyten and Martinovic, British Journal of Social Psychology 54(1), 2015

The “Great Replacement” turns demographic change into an intentional enemy

The claim

Planned replacement

Demographic change is recast as a deliberate elite plot. Popularized by Renaud Camus in 2011.

Why it appeals

Uniqueness and status

People high in need for uniqueness, and those who feel their group is under-recognized, are drawn to conspiracy explanations.

Why it matters

From text to violence

Cited by attackers in Christchurch and El Paso (2019) and Buffalo (2022). Belief in it predicts violent intentions toward Muslims.

Camus, Le Grand Remplacement (2011); Imhoff and Lamberty, European Journal of Social Psychology 47(6), 2017; Golec de Zavala and Federico, European Journal of Social Psychology 48(7), 2018; Obaidi, Kunst, Ozer and Kimel, Group Processes & Intergroup Relations 25(7), 2022

5

What reduces hostility

Exposure is not the same as contact

Brief, chaotic exposure hardens attitudes; sustained contact softens them

Greece

Exposure raised hostility

Islands near Turkey that saw large 2015 arrivals grew durably more hostile to refugees, and voted more for Golden Dawn.

Austria

Proximity lowered far-right votes

More refugees living locally reduced FPÖ support; more refugees passing through increased it.

Meta-analysis

Contact works on average

Across more than 500 studies, intergroup contact reduces prejudice.

Hangartner, Dinas, Marbach, Matakos and Xefteris, American Political Science Review 113(2), 2019; Dinas, Matakos, Xefteris and Hangartner, Political Analysis 27(2), 2019; Steinmayr, Review of Economics and Statistics 103(2), 2021; Pettigrew and Tropp, Journal of Personality and Social Psychology 90(5), 2006

Asking someone if another likes broccoli may switch the social brain on

Same photo of a homeless person	*"Does this person like this vegetable?"*	**More mPFC activity**
Same photo of a homeless person	*"Is this person over 35?"*	**Less mPFC activity**

18	Princeton undergraduates, scanned with fMRI
64	photos: disgust-quadrant groups and groups that evoke pity, envy, or pride
3.85	peak t-value, vegetable over age judgments, across all photos

An earlier study found the same vegetable task erased the amygdala gap for Black versus White faces.

Maybe?

The targets were homeless people and drug addicts, not migrants. The sample was a miniscule n=18, the group difference needed a looser statistical threshold ($p < .02$).

Harris and Fiske, Social Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience 2(1), 45–51, 2007; Harris and Fiske, Psychological Science 17(10), 2006; Wheeler and Fiske, Psychological Science 16(1), 56–63, 2005

Imagining another person's view helps in the short run, and works better when it is a real conversation

Lab experiment · Galinsky and Moskowitz (2000)

Imagine their view

Attempts to take another's perspective reduced stereotype expression, stereotype accessibility, and ingroup favoritism.

Survey experiment · Adida, Lo, and Platas (2018)

Read a refugee's story

Americans who attempted to take a Syrian refugee's perspective acted more inclusively right away. The effect was short-lived.

Field experiments · Kalla and Broockman (2020)

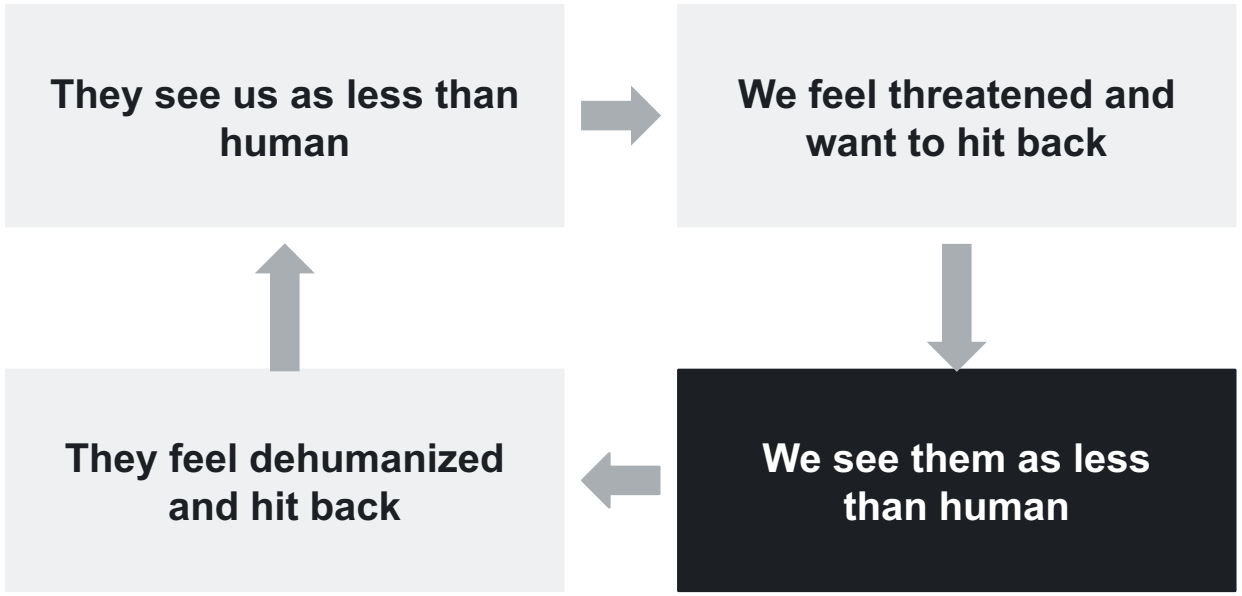
Have a conversation

Door-to-door canvassers asked residents to recall a time they were judged for being different, then linked it to unauthorized immigrants. Exclusionary attitudes declined.

Imagining a view is not the same as granting humanity. In four European samples, blatant dehumanization predicted hostility toward Muslim refugees even after controlling for trait empathy and perspective-taking.

Galinsky and Moskowitz, JPSP 78(4), 2000; Adida, Lo and Platas, PNAS 115(38), 2018; Kalla and Broockman, American Political Science Review 114(2), 2020; Bruneau, Kteily and Laustsen, European Journal of Social Psychology 48(5), 2018

Dehumanization is reciprocal, so humanization can be too



Study 6 · N = 211

Americans told that Muslims see Americans as sophisticated dehumanized Muslims less. Dislike did not change.

10-point difference Ascent rating of Muslims, humanized versus control

It runs both ways: Latino and Muslim Americans who felt dehumanized were more hostile in return.

Break the cycle at the first link: show people that the other side does not actually see them as less than human.

Kteily, Hodson and Bruneau, JPSP 110(3), 2016, Studies 6 and 7 · Kteily and Bruneau, Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin 43(1), 2017 · online US samples, fictional news report

Contact works when it is sustained, cooperative, and backed by institutions

Allport's conditions for helpful contact

Equal status	Common goals	Cooperation	Support from authorities

Brief exposure · Enos (2014) · Boston

Passing exposure hardens

Spanish-speaking confederates appeared on commuter platforms. Riders became more exclusionary toward immigration.

Sustained contact · Scacco and Warren (2018) · Nigeria

Shared classrooms cut discrimination

Christian and Muslim men were randomly assigned to mixed or same-religion classes. Mixed classes reduced discrimination in repeated behavioral games.

Cooperative contact · Mousa (2020) · Iraq

Mixed teams help, in sports

Christian players were randomly assigned to mixed or Christian-only soccer teams. Behavior toward Muslim teammates improved; it did not spread beyond the team.

Allport, The Nature of Prejudice (1954); Enos, PNAS 111(10), 2014; Scacco and Warren, American Political Science Review 112(3), 2018; Mousa, Science 369(6505), 2020

Facts alone barely help; norms and leaders set the ceiling

Moves little

Correct the numbers

Americans overestimate the immigrant share. Correcting it changed their estimates but barely changed policy views (Hopkins, Sides, and Citrin 2019).

Run a generic training

Reviews of prejudice-reduction experiments find the best evidence for contact and perspective-taking, and little for many popular approaches (Paluck and Green, 2009).

Sets the ceiling

Leaders' signals

Fiske: people act on prejudice most when stressed, pressured by peers, or when prejudice is approved by authority figures.

Perceived norms

A Rwandan radio soap-opera that modelled reconciliation and independent thinking shifted perceived norms and behavior more than private beliefs (Paluck, 2009).

Europe in 2015

Czech and Hungarian respondents rated Muslim refugees about 38 and 26 points below their own group; Greeks and Spaniards, about 15.

Hopkins, Sides, and Citrin, Journal of Politics 81(1), 2019; Paluck and Green, Annual Review of Psychology 60, 2009; Paluck, JPSP 96(3), 2009; Friedman, New York Times, Oct 31, 2018, on Fiske; Bruneau, Kteily and Laustsen, EJSP 48(5), 2018, Table 1, 3, 5, 7

What to take from today

1

The EU sets entry rights; nations decide who belongs

Most of immigration politics concerns people already in Europe, and membership is still decided in national capitals.

2

Civic integration converged, and it is mostly signaling

Different national traditions arrived at tests and contracts with more political than practical effect.

3

Hostility and acceptance are psychological: institutions help

Identity, disgust, dehumanization, nostalgia, and conspiracism explain more than economics. Quality contact reduces them.

Discussion · if time allows

If civic tests barely change outcomes but reassure some voters, are they a reasonable price for keeping the radical right out of power, or do they concede its premise?

Thursday: the United States. Same psychology, very different institutions.

POL310 · GUEST LECTURE 2 OF 2

A Nation of Immigrants

Institutions, enforcement, opinion, and partisanship in US immigration politics

Thursday, October 29, 2026 · Diego Hernandez, Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Political Science, Stony Brook University

Same psychology with different institutions

	Europe (Tuesday)	United States (today)
Founding story	Nations that became immigrant societies	A settler society that tells itself it is a nation of immigrants
Citizenship	Mostly by descent; birthright conditional at most	Birthright citizenship in the Constitution since 1868
Who governs integration	National governments, inside EU law	States and cities, with little federal integration policy
Party system	Multiparty: nativists get their own parties	Two parties: nativism competes inside one of them

Tuesday's lecture: incorporation models, civic integration, the radical right, the psychology of hostility · Brubaker (1992); Mudde (2007); Zolberg, A Nation by Design (2006)

Where today fits in the week

Course	When	Focus	What it adds
POL309	Week 10 · Oct 26, 28	The migration crisis, part I	Schengen, the asylum system, Dublin's basic rule, 2015, relocation, EU–Turkey
POL310	Tue Oct 27	Europe: who stays, and on what terms	Integration models, citizenship, civic tests, the radical right, the psychology of hostility
POL310 · today	**Thu Oct 29**	**The United States**	**Institutions, enforcement, public opinion, partisanship, and independents**
GLI330	Tue Oct 27	Dublin III up close	The hierarchy of criteria, procedures, courts, cooperation as an IR problem
GLI330	Thu Oct 29	After Dublin	Ukraine, the 2024 Pact, externalization, instrumentalization, ethics
POL309	Week 11 · Nov 2–6	The psychology of compassion	Alan Kurdi, the empathy debate

POL309 = Politics of the European Union · POL310 = Politics of Immigration and Refugees · GLI330 = Globalization and IR: Human Mobility

Today’s plan

1. The long arc: whom the United States let in, and on what terms
2. Who governs immigration: Congress, presidents, courts, and states
3. The enforcement turn of 2025 and 2026
4. Public opinion and partisanship
5. The psychology of the American debate
6. Europe and the United States compared

Guess the number

QUESTION 1

In 1910, what share of US residents were born abroad?

QUESTION 2

And today: higher or lower than in 1910?

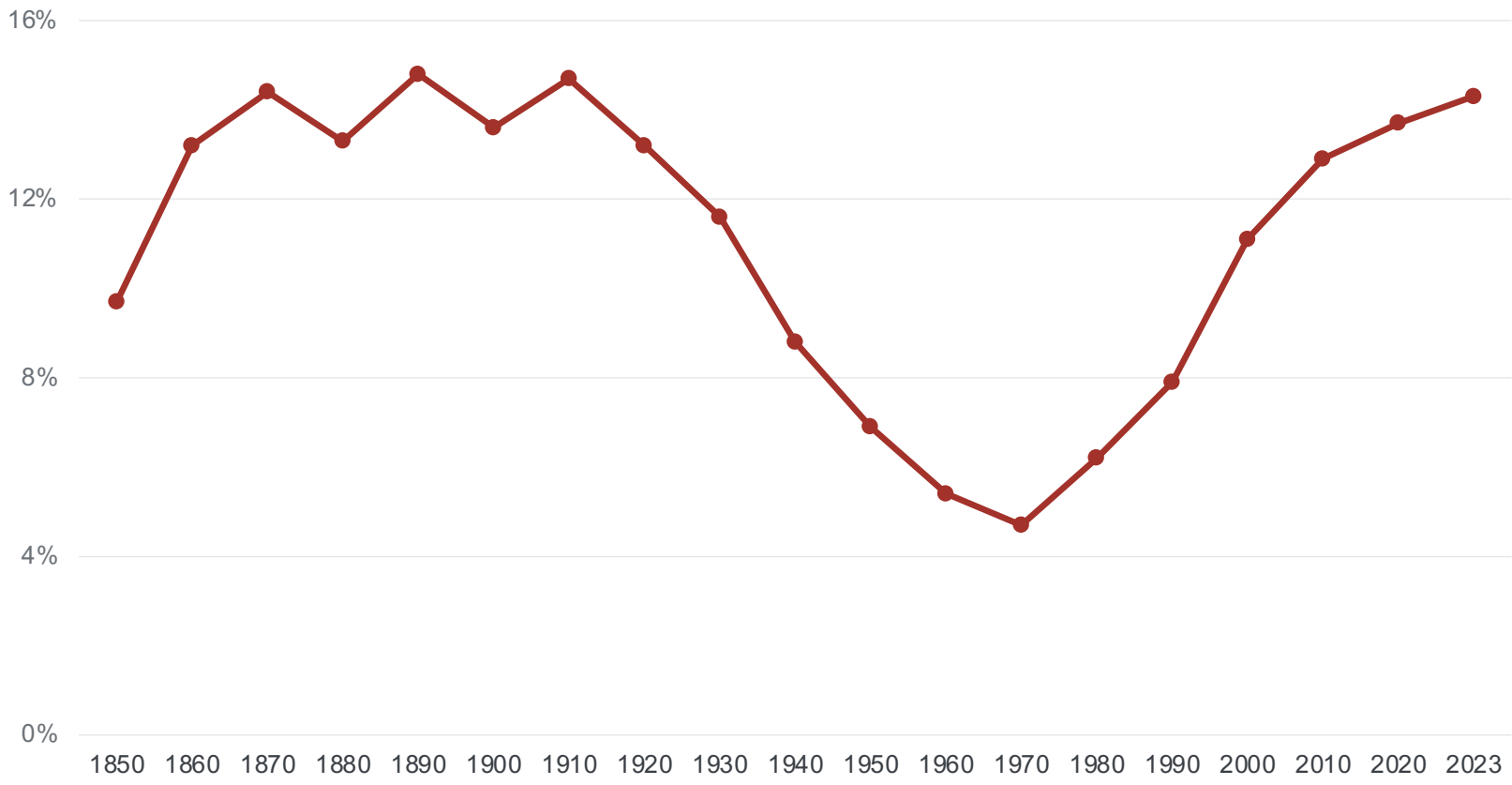
Write your guesses down. The next slide is the answer.

1

The history of US immigration

Whom the United States let in, and on what terms

The foreign-born share is back where it was in 1910



14.7%

in 1910

14.3%

in 2023

The dip was made by law: the national-origins quotas of 1924 cut immigration for four decades.

Gibson and Jung, “Historical Census Statistics on the Foreign-Born Population of the United States: 1850 to 2000,” US Census Bureau Population Division Working Paper 81 (2006); US Census Bureau, American Community Survey 1-year estimates, 2010–2023; Migration Policy Institute Data Hub

American immigration law began by defining the nation racially

1790
Naturalization limited to “free white persons”

1868
14th Amendment: birthright citizenship

1882
Chinese Exclusion Act: first ban on a nationality

1898
Wong Kim Ark: birthright applies to children of immigrants

1924
National-origins quotas favor northwestern Europeans

The Constitution opened a door that statutes kept narrowing, or tried to close.

Naturalization Act of 1790; U.S. Const. amend. XIV; Chinese Exclusion Act (1882); United States v. Wong Kim Ark, 169 U.S. 649 (1898); Immigration Act of 1924; Lee, At America’s Gates (2003); Zolberg, A Nation by Design (2006); Ngai, Impossible Subjects (2004)

1996 was the last time Congress substantially rewrote the enforcement system

1942
The Bracero program brings Mexican contract labor

1965
Hart-Celler ends national-origins quotas

1980
Refugee Act adopts the UN refugee definition

1986
IRCA: legalization for about 2.7 million; employer sanctions

1996
IIRIRA: expedited removal, reentry bars, and 287(g) agreements that let ICE deputize local police

Immigration and Nationality Act Amendments of 1965; Refugee Act of 1980; Immigration Reform and Control Act (1986); Illegal Immigration Reform and Immigrant Responsibility Act (1996); Tichenor, Dividing Lines (2002)

The undocumented population is partly a product of how the law was written and enforced

ORIGINS

From Europe to Latin America and Asia

Ending origin quotas and favoring family ties shifted where immigrants came from, beyond what sponsors predicted.

ILLEGALITY

Caps created a status

New limits on the Western Hemisphere turned long-established Mexican labor migration into “illegal” migration.

SETTLEMENT

Enforcement ended circular travel

Harder crossings after 1986 meant migrants stopped going home and stayed, with their families here.

Ngai, Impossible Subjects (2004); Massey, Durand and Malone, Beyond Smoke and Mirrors (2002); Massey, Durand and Pren, American Journal of Sociology 121(5), 2016

Top ten countries of birth of US immigrants



1 Mexico
2 India
3 China
4 Philippines
5 El Salvador
6 Vietnam
7 Cuba
8 Dominican Republic
9 Guatemala
10 South Korea

US Census Bureau, American Community Survey 2023 1-year estimates (table B05006); Migration Policy Institute Data Hub

Birthright citizenship: a rule Europe does not have

“All persons born or naturalized in the United States, and subject to the jurisdiction thereof, are citizens…”

14th Amendment, 1868

- Wong Kim Ark (1898) applies it to children of non-citizens
- Unusual among rich democracies; standard in the Americas

THE CHALLENGE · EXECUTIVE ORDER 14160, 2025

Jan 2025	Order would deny citizenship to children of undocumented and temporary residents. Blocked by lower courts.
Jun 2025	Trump v. CASA, 6–3: federal courts may not issue “universal” injunctions; the order’s legality left open.
Jun 2026	Trump v. Barbara, 6–3: the order is unconstitutional. The 14th Amendment covers children born on US soil regardless of parents’ status.

U.S. Const. amend. XIV, §1; United States v. Wong Kim Ark, 169 U.S. 649 (1898); Executive Order 14160 (Jan. 20, 2025); Trump v. CASA, Inc., 606 U.S. ___ (2025); Trump v. Barbara (2026)

2

Who governs immigration?

Congress, presidents, courts, and states

Gridlock does not freeze policy. It moves policymaking to presidents and courts

2006 — Senate passes reform; the House does not take it up

2007 — Reform bill dies in the Senate

2013 — Senate passes S. 744, 68–32; the House never votes on it

2018 — DACA deals fail in both chambers

2024 — Bipartisan border bill fails in the Senate

Senate roll-call votes on S. 2611 (2006), S. 1348 cloture (2007), S. 744 (2013, 68–32), and H.R. 815 border provisions, cloture (Feb. 2024); Congressional Record; Gimpel and Edwards, The Congressional Politics of Immigration Reform (1999)

Presidents of both parties have governed immigration by executive action

Instrument	President	What it did
DACA (2012)	Obama	Deferred removal and work permits for people brought as children; over 800,000 recipients
Travel ban (2017)	Trump	Barred entry from several Muslim-majority countries; upheld in Trump v. Hawaii (2018)
“Zero tolerance” (2018)	Trump	Prosecuted all irregular entrants, separating thousands of children from parents
Title 42 (2020–23)	Trump, Biden	Public-health expulsions at the border without asylum screening
Parole programs (2023)	Biden	Legal entry routes for some nationalities; appointments through the CBP One app
Asylum restriction (2024)	Biden	Limited asylum at the southern border when crossings were high

Executive actions as published in the Federal Register; Trump v. Hawaii, 585 U.S. 667 (2018); HHS Office of Inspector General, report on separated children (2019); USCIS DACA data

Courts defer on who may enter, and scrutinize how the executive decides

2012
Arizona v. US: most of SB 1070 preempted by federal law

2016
US v. Texas: a 4–4 split blocks DAPA

2018
Trump v. Hawaii: travel ban upheld

2020
DHS v. Regents: DACA rescission set aside on procedure

2025
Trump v. CASA: limits on universal injunctions

Arizona v. United States, 567 U.S. 387 (2012); United States v. Texas, 579 U.S. 547 (2016); Trump v. Hawaii, 585 U.S. 667 (2018); DHS v. Regents of the Univ. of California, 591 U.S. 1 (2020); Trump v. CASA, Inc., 606 U.S. ___ (2025)

Fifty immigration policies: states pull in opposite directions

RESTRICTIVE STATES

Enforcement from below

– Arizona SB 1070 (2010): “show me your papers”
– Texas: Operation Lone Star (2021) and SB 4 (2023), making illegal entry a state crime
– Busing migrants to New York and Chicago (2022–23)
– 287(g) agreements with ICE expand in 2025

INTEGRATIVE STATES

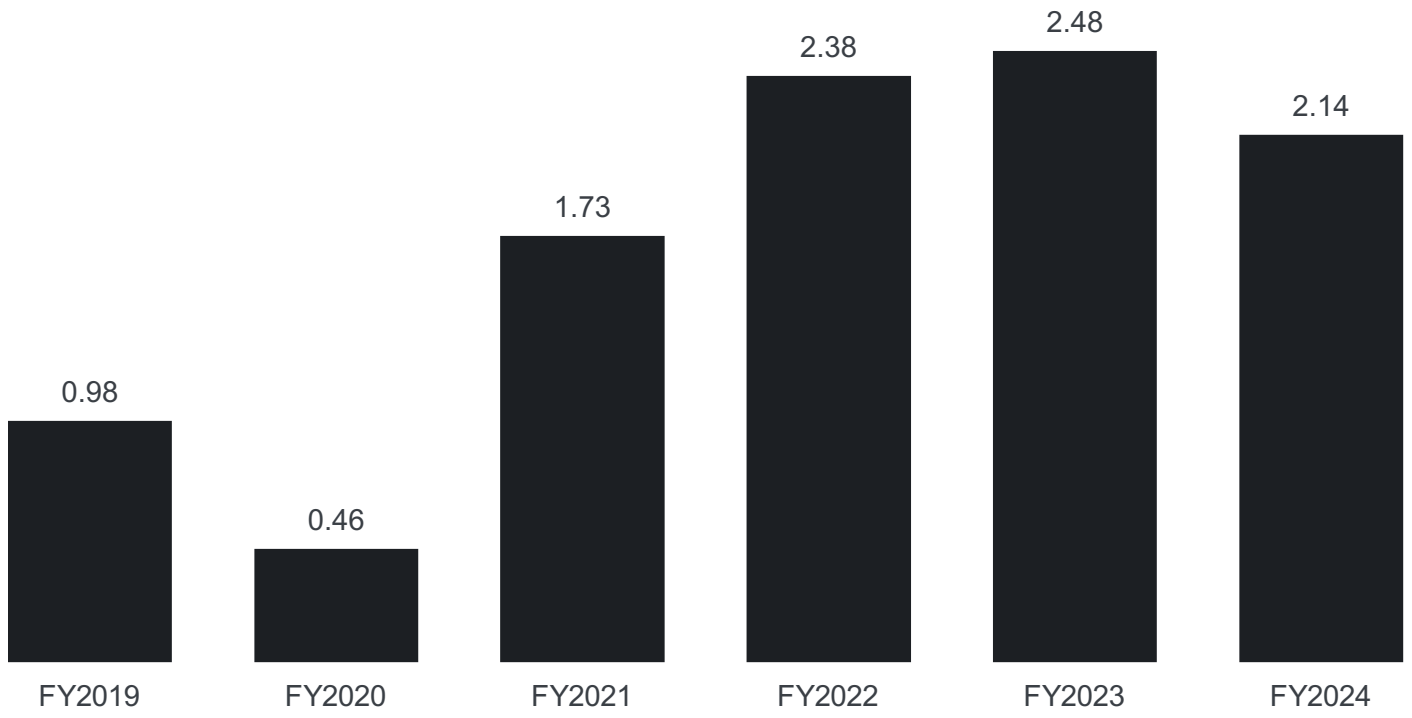
Incorporation from below

– Sanctuary policies limit cooperation with ICE
– In-state tuition for undocumented students
– Driver’s licenses regardless of status
– State-funded legal aid and health coverage in some states

National Conference of State Legislatures, state immigration legislation reports; ICE, 287(g) program data; Gulasekaram and Ramakrishnan, The New Immigration Federalism (2015)

Border encounters peaked in FY2023, then fell to multi-decade lows

SOUTHWEST BORDER ENCOUNTERS, MILLIONS



2.48m

encounters in FY2023, the peak

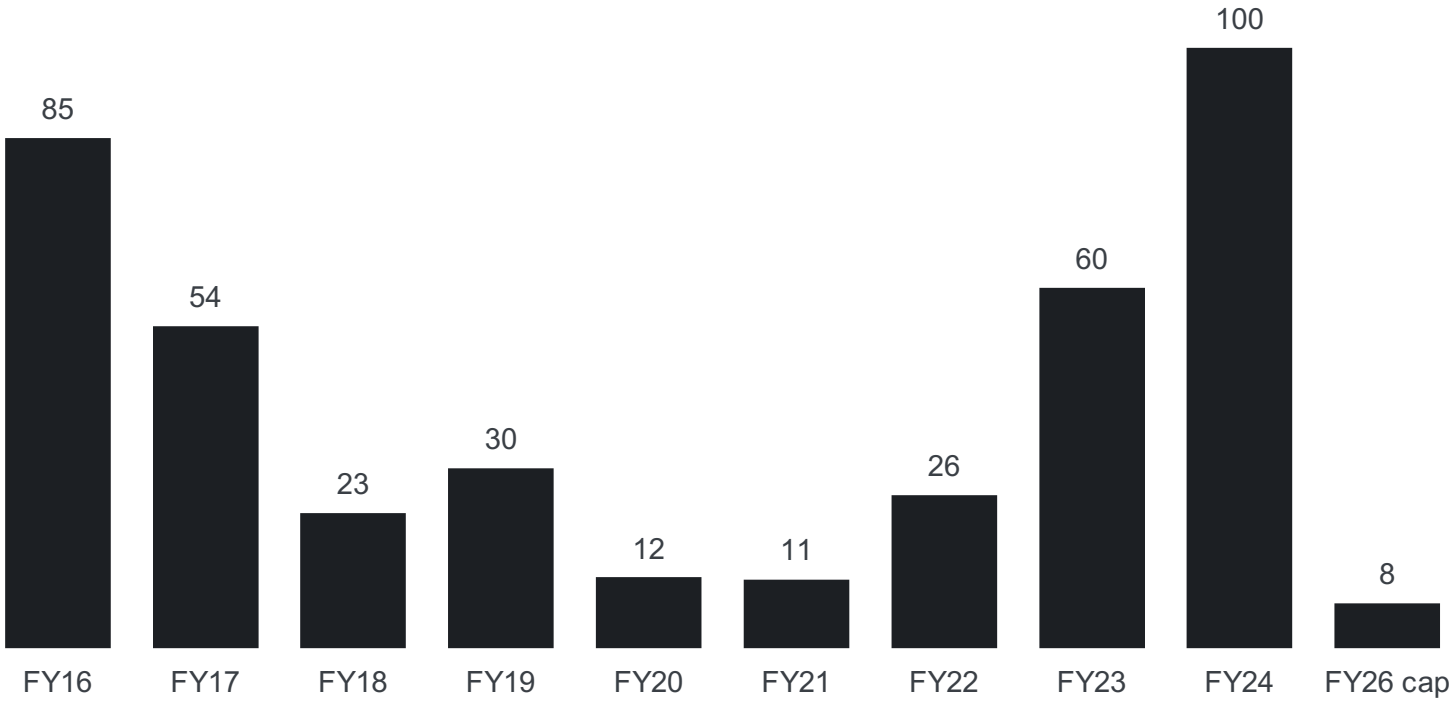
Encounters count events, not individuals: repeat crossings under Title 42 inflate the totals.

In 2025, monthly encounters fell to their lowest levels in decades.

US Customs and Border Protection, Southwest Land Border Encounters (fiscal years, millions, rounded)

Refugee admissions: from 100,000 to a ceiling of 7,500

REFUGEE ADMISSIONS, THOUSANDS



7,500

refugee ceiling for FY2026, the lowest since the Refugee Act of 1980

Resettlement selects people abroad. Asylum is claimed at or inside the border.

US Department of State, Refugee Processing Center admissions data; Presidential Determinations on Refugee Admissions, FY2024 and FY2026 · thousands, rounded

3

The enforcement turn

2025–26: from the border to the interior

2025: a year of executive and legislative action

Jan 20
Border emergency declared; refugee admissions suspended; birthright order; CBP One ended

Jan 29
Laken Riley Act, the term's first law: detention of noncitizens charged with certain crimes

Mar 15
Alien Enemies Act of 1798 invoked; Venezuelans flown to a Salvadoran prison before they could contest removal

Jun
National Guard federalized and deployed in Los Angeles amid protests

Jul 4
Budget law funds a major expansion of enforcement, detention, and ICE hiring

Oct
FY2026 refugee ceiling set at 7,500

Executive Orders 14159, 14160, 14163, 14165 (Jan. 20, 2025); Laken Riley Act, Pub. L. 119-1; Proclamation invoking the Alien Enemies Act (Mar. 15, 2025); Trump v. J.G.G. (U.S., Apr. 7, 2025); Presidential memorandum of June 7, 2025; Pub. L. 119-21 (July 4, 2025); Presidential Determination on Refugee Admissions for FY2026

Congress could not agree on legalization for three decades, but it could agree on enforcement money

≈$170bn

for border security, detention, and immigration enforcement in the 2025 budget law

≈$45bn

of that for ICE detention alone, through 2029

7,500

refugee ceiling for FY2026, down from 125,000 in FY2024

Pub. L. 119-21 (2025), Titles on Homeland Security and Judiciary; Congressional Budget Office cost estimate for H.R. 1 (2025); Presidential Determinations on Refugee Admissions, FY2024 and FY2026 · rounded

Three lenses on the enforcement turn

HOLLIFIELD

The liberal paradox

Liberal states need open markets and must protect rights, yet must also control borders to remain sovereign.

FREEMAN

Client politics, broken

Concentrated benefits for employers once beat diffuse costs. High salience turns immigration into mass politics.

INSTITUTIONS

Who checks the executive?

Congress funds, courts referee, states resist or assist. Non-citizens cannot vote on any of it.

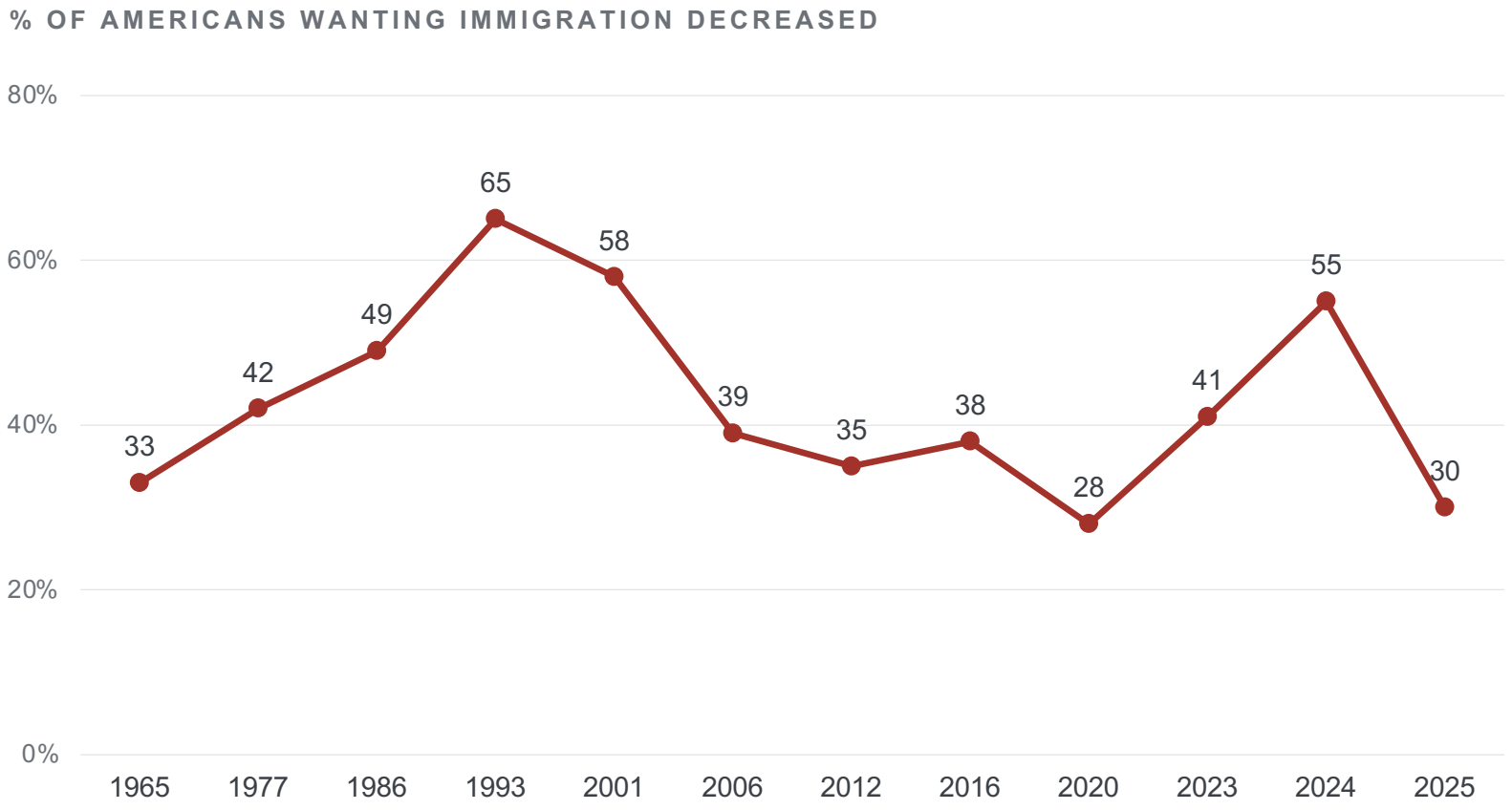
Hollifield, International Migration Review 38(3), 2004; Freeman, International Migration Review 29(4), 1995; Hollifield, Martin and Orrenius, eds., Controlling Immigration, 3rd ed. (2014)

4

Opinion and partisanship

Thermostats, sorting, and the people who refuse a label

Opinion is thermostatic: it moves against the direction of policy



55% → 30%

Between 2024 and 2025, as policy swung toward restriction, the public swung the other way.

Gallup, “Should immigration be kept at its present level, increased or decreased?”, selected years (2001 = October); Wlezien, American Journal of Political Science 39(4), 1995; Soroka and Wlezien, Degrees of Democracy (2010)

Local change becomes local hostility when national rhetoric politicizes it

Sudden local change
A town's immigrant population grows quickly

×

National salience
Leaders and media frame immigration as a crisis

→

Local hostility
Restrictive local ordinances, opposition votes

Demographic change is a constant of life on this planet. Rhetoric is what makes it feel threatening; without it, change does not produce border politics.

Hopkins, "Politicized Places," American Political Science Review 104(1), 2010; Newman, American Journal of Political Science 57(2), 2013

Europe built new parties for nativism. In the United States, nativism reshaped a major party

ABRAJANO AND HAJNAL (2015)

White backlash

– Concern about immigration moved white voters toward the Republican Party
– The effect built over decades, not in one election

SIDES, TESLER AND VAVRECK (2018)

Identity crisis

– In 2016, immigration attitudes became a much stronger predictor of the vote
– Candidates activated existing attitudes rather than creating them

Abrajano and Hajnal, White Backlash (2015); Hajnal and Rivera, American Journal of Political Science 58(4), 2014; Sides, Tesler and Vavreck, Identity Crisis (2018); Jardina, White Identity Politics (2019)

The Americans who refuse a label

≈4 in 10

Americans call themselves independent, more than identify with either party.

But most independents lean toward a party and vote like partisans. Many hide their partisanship because party labels have become embarrassing.

OPEN QUESTIONS

Do leaners follow their party on immigration?

Or is immigration where hidden partisans reveal themselves?

Are pure independents cross-pressured?

Restrictive on the border, generous toward long-settled neighbors?

Does the issue push people into labels, or out of them?

Salient, polarizing issues may make a label feel costlier to wear.

Gallup, party identification, 2024 annual average; Keith et al., The Myth of the Independent Voter (1992); Petrocik, Electoral Studies 28(4), 2009; Klar and Krupnikov, Independent Politics (2016)

Label check

1

Your label

Democrat, Republican, independent, or none of these?

2

Your lean

If independent or none, do you lean toward a party? Which?

3

Your view

On immigration, do you agree with that party? Where do you part ways?

4

Your pair

Compare with a neighbor. Did the label go along with your view?

Labels are claims about identity. Issue positions do not always follow them.

Immigrant-origin voters do not automatically vote as an immigrant-interest bloc

THE SHIFT

Close to even in 2024

After favoring Democrats by about 21 points in 2020, Latino voters split nearly evenly.

HETEROGENEITY

Not one bloc

Cuban, Mexican, Puerto Rican, Venezuelan, and Dominican Americans differ in history, status, and politics.

CROSS-PRESSURE

Border versus neighbors

Many support border control while opposing removals of long-settled residents.

Pew Research Center, validated voter studies of the 2020 (2021) and 2024 (2025) electorates; Abrajano and Alvarez, New Faces, New Voices (2010); Beltrán, The Trouble with Unity (2010)

5

The psychology of the American debate

Dehumanizing rhetoric, rumor, and what changes minds

Tuesday's mechanisms return: dehumanization predicts policy views in the US too

RHETORIC

"Animals," "invasion," "poisoning the blood," "eating the dogs"

Said by Donald Trump about immigrants, 2018–2024.

MEASUREMENT

Less "evolved" ratings

US respondents who rated Mexican immigrants as less evolved backed harsher policies.

WHO DEHUMANIZES

It is not random

Dehumanization of immigrants in the US tracks political ideology and policy preferences.

Kteily and Bruneau, Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin 43(1), 2017; Markowitz and Slovic, PNAS 117(17), 2020; Utych, Political Research Quarterly 71(2), 2018

Springfield, 2024: rumors spread when a topic is important, ambiguous, and fits a group's fears

Aug 2024

Local social media posts claim Haitian migrants are eating pets

Sep 10

The claim is repeated by Donald Trump in a presidential debate

Sep

Officials say there is no evidence; bomb threats close schools and public buildings

Throughout

Many Haitian residents hold legal Temporary Protected Status or parole

$$rumor \approx importance \times ambiguity$$

Allport and Postman's "basic law of rumor," 1947

City of Springfield, Ohio, public statements, September 2024; ABC News presidential debate transcript, Sept. 10, 2024; Allport and Postman, The Psychology of Rumor (1947); DiFonzo and Bordia, Rumor Psychology (2007)

Attitudes rooted in identity respond to relationships more than to statistics

HOPKINS, SIDES AND CITRIN (2019)

Correct facts have muted effects

- Americans overestimate the immigrant share of the population
- Telling them the right number corrects the belief
- But attitudes toward immigration barely move

KALLA AND BROOCKMAN (2020)

Narratives that stick

- Canvassers share and invite personal stories, without judgment
- Exclusionary attitudes fall, and the effect lasts for months
- Replicated across three field experiments

Hopkins, Sides and Citrin, Journal of Politics 81(1), 2019; Grigorieff, Roth and Ubfal, Review of Income and Wealth 66(3), 2020; Kalla and Broockman, American Political Science Review 114(2), 2020

6

Europe and the United States compared

What the two days give us

A comparative look at immigration politics and policy

	European Union	United States
Citizenship	Mostly by descent; naturalization after tests	Birthright in the Constitution
Integration policy	National, with civic tests and contracts	Largely state and local; little federal policy
Where nativism lives	Separate radical right parties	Inside one of two major parties
Main enforcement strategy	Externalization to partner states	Interior removal and border deterrence
Courts	European courts constrain transfers and detention	Courts mostly defer on entry and police procedure
Shared psychology	Identity threat, disgust, dehumanization, nostalgia	The same, and the same remedies: contact and conversation

GLI330 students: externalization was the subject of today's GLI330 lecture · Sources as cited on Tuesday's and today's slides

What to take from today

1

Gridlock moves power toward the executive

With Congress stalled since 1996, presidents govern by executive action, courts referee, and states pull in opposite directions.

2

Immigration opinion is thermostatic

The public reacts against the direction of policy. Partisanship has sorted immigration attitudes, but labels do not fully predict views.

3

Psychology, yes, but institutions, too

The same mechanisms produce radical right parties in Europe and a transformed major party in the United States.

FOR DISCUSSION

Is the United States becoming more "European" in its immigration politics, or is Europe becoming more "American"?

Use at least one piece of evidence from Tuesday and one from today.